Sepsis & Specific Infections – Section Summary

Tick-borne • Meningitis • Tropical • Endocarditis • Pleural infection

Critical Care Board Review • Section 19 • MCQ-Oriented

1. Tick-borne

- Babesiosis (severe) → **quinine + clindamycin** (or atovaquone + azithro); exchange if severe
- RMSF: IFA serology gold standard; treat with **doxycycline** empirically
- Lyme: **CN VII palsy** most common; tick bite prophylaxis **doxycycline 200 mg once**

2. CNS

- Bacterial CSF: high pressure, **neutrophils, high protein, low glucose**
- Meningococcal prophylaxis: **ceftriaxone 250 mg IM** (or cipro/rifampin)
- Tremor + flaccid weakness + encephalitis → **West Nile**

3. Tropical & Zoonoses

- Dengue: bleeding/warning signs = **severe dengue**; 2nd serotype → ↑ severe risk
- Leptospirosis: fresh water, jaundice, AKI
- Glanders (horses) → **B. mallei**
- Inhalational anthrax → **cipro + clindamycin** (+ antitoxin)
- Ebola: asymptomatic contact > 21 d → no monitoring needed

4. Endocarditis & Others

- Prosthetic valve IE with HF/abscess → **surgery**
- Culture-negative IE → **Bartonella, Coxiella, Tropheryma** serology
- Pyelonephritis in pregnancy → **cefepime**/ceftriaxone
- TB pericarditis with tamponade → **pericardiocentesis**
- Loculated empyema → **tPA 10 mg + DNase 5 mg**; TB pleuritis → **ADA**
- Neurosyphilis → penicillin G (procaine + probenecid alternative)

5. High-Yield MCQ Pearls

- ☑ Culture-negative IE: Bartonella/Coxiella
- ☑ Empyema: tPA + DNase

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